QP CODE: 25900215

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION MARCH 2025

SECOND SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG2DSCTTM100 - TOURISM BUSINESS MANAGEMENT

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1.5 Hours **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Short Answer Questions

Answer any **5** questions

Each question carries **2** marks

1. Define Horizontal integration. [K] / [CO1, CO3]

   Horizontal integration is a business strategy where a company acquires or merges with other companies operating at the same level of the value chain in the same industry. (2 Marks for correct definition)

2. Who is known as the father of travel agency business and why? [U] / [CO2]

   Thomas Cook is known as the "Father of the Travel Agency Business" because he established the first modern travel agency, Thomas Cook & Son, in 1841.Also he operated the first package tour in the world.(2 marks for three points)

3. Mention the advantages of package trips. [U] / [CO2]

   Cost saving, Convenience and time saving, Expert guidance and local insights, More safety, Social Opportunities, Structured itinerary with flexibility, Stress free travel. (2 marks for any three points)

4. What are the responsibilities of a tour operator? [U] / [CO2]

   Planning, Development, Promotion, Administration and implementation of tourism products (2 marks for four points)

5. Name two major modes of tourist travel. [K] / [CO3]

   Air Travel

   Rail Travel

   Water Transportation

   Road Transportation

   (2 marks for any two modes)

6. Name two famous cruise lines operating globally. [K] / [CO3]

   2 marks for any two cruise lines answered. Major popular ones are

   P&O Cruises, Royal Caribbean, Cunard, MSC, Marella Cruises etc

   (2 marks for any two cruise lines)

7. Give two examples of alternative accommodations. [K] / [CO4]

   2 marks for any two supplementary accommodations answered. Common Types are Vacation Rentals, Homestays, Caravans and Camping Sites, B& B establishments, Youth hostels, lodges, Guest houses, Dharmasala etc.

   (2 marks for any two units)

8. What is the difference between a hostel and a motel? [U] / [CO4]

   A hostel offers dormitory-style rooms or private rooms with shared bathrooms, often targeting budget travelers and social interaction

   Motels are located on highway sides targeting motor travellers

[2x5 = 10]

Part B

Short Essay Questions

Answer any **5** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

9. Explain the issues faced in supply. [U] / [CO1, CO3]

   Wrong question, It doesn't mentions the tourism supply. Can give five marks for the attempt

10. Differentiate between travel Agency and tour operation bussiness. [U] / [CO2]

    Travel Agency:

    Focus: Facilitating bookings and providing travel services (flights, hotels, tours) based on individual client needs.

    Role: Acts as a consultant and bridge between travelers and travel service providers.

    Service: Offers personalized recommendations and assistance with bookings and travel arrangements.

Control: Relies on partnerships with tour operators and other suppliers.

Commission: Earns a commission on the services they book.

Specialization: May specialize in certain types of travel (e.g., luxury, adventure).

Tour Operator:

Focus: Designing, assembling, and selling complete travel packages (flights, hotels, excursions).

Role: Acts as a "manufacturer" of tourism products, creating and managing tour packages.

Service: Offers pre-packaged tours with a fixed itinerary and little room for customization.

Control: Manages the entire tour experience, from planning to execution.

Profit: Earns a profit from the sale of their tour packages.

Specialization: May specialize in certain regions, types of travel, or target demographics.

(5 marks for five differences)

11 Discuss the CRS? Explain is functions. [U] / [CO2]

CRS is a computerized platform used to manage and distribute travel-related products like flights, hotels, car rentals, and tours

Functions:

Displaying travel options with prices and visuals

Managing inventory and reservations

Facilitating online payments

Handling customer data

Managing bookings, cancellations, and refunds

(5 marks for definition with at least 5 functions)

12 Explain the role of travel agency and its features. [U] / [CO2]

A travel agency is a business that assists clients with planning and booking travel arrangements, offering services like flight and accommodation booking, itinerary creation, and travel advice.

Key features:

Booking services

Providing information

Offering customer service

Facilitating negotiations with suppliers.

(5 marks for meaning with at least five features)

13. Describe how railway stations act as tourist hubs in major destinations [U] / [CO3]

Transportation Hubs:

Railway stations are crucial for connecting different regions and serving as a primary transportation point for tourists arriving from other locations.

Accessibility to Tourist Spots:

They provide easy access to various attractions and cultural sites, making it convenient for tourists to explore the area.

Attractions in Themselves:

Some railway stations are designed to be visually appealing and historical landmarks, drawing tourists to explore their architecture and history.

Additional Amenities:

Many stations offer various amenities like retail spaces, restaurants, and parking facilities, enhancing the experience for both locals and tourists.

Tourist Information and Services:

Stations often serve as points of information, providing maps, guides, and assistance to tourists, further enhancing the overall experience.

Promotional and Package Deals:

Railway operators may offer special trains, luxury carriages, and tour packages to promote tourism, making rail travel an attractive option for tourists..

(5 marks for at least five services)

14. Explain the role of road transport in connecting remote tourist destinations. [U] / [CO3]

Tourists would be unable to access tourist destinations without a robust road transportation system.

It serves as a vital link between the points of origin and the areas where it will be used.

It makes it easier for vacationers, business travellers, educational purpose, individuals visiting friends and relatives etc.

(5 marks for at least three services)

15. What is a heritage hotel? Explain. [U] / [CO4]

A heritage hotel is a hotel located within a building of historical or cultural significance, often a former palace, fort, or mansion.

Features:

Historical Significance:

The building itself is a historical landmark or a building that once served a significant purpose (e.g., a palace, fort, haveli, or hunting lodge).

Unique Experience:

Heritage hotels provide a distinctive experience that goes beyond standard luxury accommodations.

Cultural Immersion:

They often feature local cuisines, traditional activities, and heritage walks that allow guests to connect with the local culture.

Architectural and Design:

The architecture and design of the hotel typically reflect the building's historical period and the local architectural style.

(5 marks for meaning with at least four features)

16. What are the main components of MICE tourism? [U] / [CO4]

Meetings

Incentives

Conventions/Conferences

Exhibitions/Events

(5 marks for four components with explanation)

[5x5 = 25]

Part C

Long Essay Questions

Answer any **1** question

Each question carries **15** marks

17. Identify the future trends of tour operation business. [U] / [CO2]

Increased reliance on technology like AI

Growing emphasis on sustainability and responsible tourism

shift towards experiential and niche travel offerings.

(15 marks for at least five trends with explanation)

18. Discuss the major air charter service providers in India and their contribution to tourism. [U] / [CO3]

JetSetGo:

JetSetGo is a prominent player in aircraft leasing, facilitating access to remote destinations and offering a more personalized travel experience.

Air Charter Service India:

Air Charter Service India provides a range of charter options, including private jets, helicopters, and executive airliners, catering to both business and leisure travel.

Taj Air:

Taj Air specializes in luxury charter services, known for its hospitality and the world-renowned standards of Taj Hotels Palaces Resorts Safaris.

Other Notable Providers:

Other key players include NetJets, NetJets, VistaJet, Air One, Club One

Air, and Ether Charters Private Ltd.

Contribution to Tourism:

Increasing Accessibility: Allowing travelers to access destinations that may be difficult to reach via traditional airlines.

Enhancing Flexibility: Providing personalized schedules and itineraries, catering to specific needs and preferences.

Creating Luxury Experiences: Offering a more comfortable, private, and exclusive travel experience, particularly appealing to high-end tourists.

Supporting Tourism in Remote Areas: Facilitating tourism in areas that may not have well-developed infrastructure, such as certain national parks or heritage sites.

(15 marks for explaining five services with examples)

19 Compare independent hotels and franchise hotels with examples. [U] / [CO4]

Independent Hotels:

Ownership & Management:

Owned and operated by individuals or small groups, offering a personal touch.

Branding & Flexibility:

Freedom to create a unique brand identity, design, and guest experience, allowing for customization and personalization. .

Franchise Hotels:

Ownership & Management:

Operated by individuals or groups who pay a fee to use a recognized brand's name, systems, and support.

Branding & Standards:

Follow standardized brand guidelines for design, service, and operations, ensuring consistency across locations.

(15 marks for meaning with at least five differences with explanation)

[15x1 = 15]